

CORTORA

Order Statuses, Delivery Issues, and Operational Procedures

Document ID	Version	Owner	Classification	Effective	Review cycle
COR-SOP-022	2.0	Order Operations	Internal	01 September 2026	Annual

This Standard Operating Procedure describes the order statuses used across Cortora's systems, common delivery and fulfillment exceptions, and the steps Order Operations staff and OpsPilot should follow to investigate and resolve them.

1. Order Status Reference

Status	Meaning	Typical duration
PENDING	Order created; payment authorizing or awaiting capture; not yet sent to fulfillment.	Minutes to a few hours
PROCESSING	Payment captured; order sent to the fulfillment centre for picking and packing.	Up to 2 business days
SHIPPED	Order has left the fulfillment centre and is with the carrier.	1–5 business days depending on service level
DELIVERED	Carrier has confirmed delivery.	N/A
CANCELLED	Order will not be fulfilled.	N/A
RETURNED	A delivered order has had some or all items returned and accepted.	N/A

2. Stuck-in-Processing Investigation

An order is considered stuck when it remains in PROCESSING beyond the expected fulfillment window. Investigate as follows:

- Confirm the payment status is CAPTURED; an order will not proceed to fulfillment on an uncaptured payment.
- Check the fulfillment centre queue for the order to identify whether it is awaiting stock, awaiting a quality check, or genuinely delayed without cause.
- If the item is out of stock and cannot be restocked within the customer's expected timeframe, offer cancellation under the Cancellation Policy or a substitute item with the customer's consent.
- If the delay is a fulfillment centre backlog with no stock issue, provide the customer a revised estimate rather than a firm new date unless the fulfillment centre has confirmed one.

3. Delivery Delay and Non-Delivery Investigation

- Retrieve the carrier tracking record associated with the shipment.
- If tracking shows normal movement but has not reached the destination, compare elapsed transit time against the expected window in the Shipping & Delivery Policy before treating the shipment as delayed.

- If tracking has not updated for longer than the carrier's normal scan interval, treat the shipment as potentially lost and open an investigation with the carrier per the Shipping & Delivery Policy.
- If the carrier confirms the shipment is lost, or the maximum expected transit time has been exceeded without delivery, the order becomes eligible for a full refund or reshipment under the Refund Policy, at the customer's choice where stock allows.

4. Incorrect Status Transitions

Occasionally an order's status does not match its physical state — for example, a system shows DELIVERED but the customer has not received the item, or shows SHIPPED with no corresponding carrier record. These cases should not be resolved by manually editing the order status. Instead, escalate to Technology & Data to investigate the underlying system event, and use the customer's evidence (or lack of a carrier record) to proceed with a delivery investigation under Section 3 in parallel.

5. Address Problems

- Incomplete or invalid address caught before shipment: contact the customer to confirm a corrected address before releasing the order to the carrier.
- Address error discovered after shipment: contact the carrier to request an in-transit redirection where supported; if not supported, treat the shipment as at risk of non-delivery and follow Section 3 once the expected delivery window has passed.
- Customer disputes the delivery address on file: verify the address used for the specific order against the order record, since the account's default address may differ from the one used at checkout.

6. Fulfillment Discrepancies

A fulfillment discrepancy occurs when the item shipped does not match the Order Item record — wrong product, wrong quantity, or missing item from a multi-item order. Confirm the discrepancy against the original Order Item record, not the customer's memory of what they ordered, then route the case to the Return Policy's WRONG_ITEM handling for the affected item while leaving correctly fulfilled items unaffected.

7. Return-Triggered Order Updates

When a Return record reaches ACCEPTED or ACCEPTED_WITH_DEDUCTION, the corresponding Order Item should be updated to reflect the returned status once the refund has been processed, so the order's history accurately reflects what was ultimately kept by the customer.

8. Role of OpsPilot

OpsPilot may retrieve order and tracking status, apply the investigation steps in Sections 2 to 6, and recommend the appropriate next action (revised estimate, cancellation offer, refund evaluation, or escalation). OpsPilot must not alter an order's status directly; it may only recommend an action to be executed through the appropriate service, subject to the requesting employee's authorization.

9. Related Documents

- Shipping & Delivery Policy — governs expected transit times and carrier investigation steps.
 - Cancellation Policy — governs cancelling an order affected by a fulfillment exception.
 - Refund Policy and Return Policy — govern the financial and physical resolution of fulfillment exceptions.
 - Escalation Procedures — governs routing of system-level status discrepancies.
-

Synthetic environment notice: Cortora, its employees, customers, policies, and operational records are fictional and created solely for the OpsPilot engineering project.